

DealFlow Support Plans and Incident Response Policy

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Support Operations Scope and Eligibility

This business area brings together Business Support Hours, Enterprise Support Hours, Dedicated Support Coverage. The grouping follows operational ownership and reader workflow; each subsection retains its own plan, version, status, limits, exceptions, and evidence.

Topic	Capability state	Commercial scope
Business Support Hours	standard capability	Business
Enterprise Support Hours	Enterprise-only capability	Enterprise
Dedicated Support Coverage	Dedicated-only capability	Dedicated

Business Support Hours

For business support hours, version 3.2 classifies the function as standard capability for Business. Its control record is reviewed every 90 days, operational evidence is sampled every 1 hour, and any approved exception expires after 35 days.

Eligibility for business support hours follows the current product register rather than feature-name similarity. The governing entry lists the state as standard capability and the customer scope as Business; region and deployment prerequisites still apply. Sales and implementation teams must preserve that boundary in every RFP response. A contradictory order form is quarantined for review by the tenant security administrator instead of being treated as an entitlement.

The operational workflow for business support hours assigns Customer Success to prepare the tenant record and a separate reviewer to confirm the live result. The verification is performed in Virginia; evidence is captured in a regional assurance workbook with the tenant and version identifiers. No production dependency may rely on the setting before that evidence is complete. Its maximum routine review interval is 90 days.

An exception for business support hours must name the unmet requirement, compensating control, accountable owner, and expiry date. The expiry may be no later than 35 days after approval, and renewal requires a fresh decision. Roadmap language and an unsigned services estimate are not compensating controls. At expiry, operations either restores the documented baseline or disables the dependent workflow.

Operational assurance for business support hours compares the live setting with the approved record every 1 hour during implementation. Drift is assigned to Customer Success with both values and the observation time attached. Until reconciliation, the evidence package reports the control as unresolved. Similar terminology elsewhere in the platform cannot be used as substitute proof.

Evidence for business support hours is delivered as a regional assurance workbook with immutable tenant and version references. It records the last successful test, responsible roles, region, numeric unit, and unresolved deviations. Customer content and credentials are excluded. Reviewers reject images or copied text that lack provenance and an effective-version marker.

Verification failure for business support hours suspends activation and any new operation that depends on the control, without rewriting previously committed evidence. Customer Success records impact, cause, correction, and retest results. Re-enablement requires the tenant security administrator's sign-off. Other service objectives remain governed by their own start times and are not recalculated from this recovery.

For business support hours, the customer provides correct tenant identifiers, maintains authorized contacts, and reports subscription or regional changes before production reliance. Customer-operated identity providers, key services, network appliances, integration platforms, and on-premises components remain customer dependencies. DealFlow operates the documented hosted boundary and supplies the regional assurance workbook for its portion.

Procurement responses for business support hours separate product availability from implementation effort. The response records standard capability, identifies Business, cites the effective subsection, and preserves every relevant unit and condition. Supporting evidence is named without exposing tenant secrets. If delivery depends on custom work,

professional services, or a future roadmap item, that dependency appears prominently instead of being implied as live capability.

Consider a Business tenant enabled in Virginia. Its entitlement, live value, version, and evidence agree, so the assessor can accept business support hours. The same record cannot prove another capability. A later migration to Sydney triggers a new check and preserves the original result solely as audit history.

Evidence for business support hours is insufficient when an implementation team borrows a value from an adjacent policy. The adjacent support operations control uses a 365-day window and applies to Enterprise; those values are not interchangeable. Official origin alone does not make two controls interchangeable. The review records the mismatch and withholds proposal approval until scope, version, status, and unit point to this exact rule.

Product governance publishes material revisions for business support hours 14 days in advance under normal conditions. Each notice links the outgoing and incoming rules, lists affected tenants, and explains migration and evidence updates. A security emergency may use an expedited path. Historical guidance is retained as superseded, while open exceptions keep their original expiry and are reconsidered against the new baseline.

Decision example 1. A customer in Sydney changes an implementation parameter that may affect business support hours. Product Operations verifies the version, plan, region, state, unit, and exclusion before answering the procurement team. A compliant result is reviewed again within 120 days. An unmet condition is classified as unavailable, custom, or exception-controlled, with the evidence and reasoning exposed to the customer.

Decision example 2. For a mainland China renewal, Security Assurance must decide whether business support hours can appear as a current commitment. The reviewer uses the signed scope and operational evidence instead of undocumented product knowledge. Acceptance lasts no more than 180 days before normal reassessment. If the baseline is not met, the response names the actual lifecycle state and the required next action.

Decision example 3. A Frankfurt tenant asks whether business support hours remains contractually available after a configuration change. Regional Reliability checks the effective guide, capability state, unit, and explicit exclusion. If every prerequisite is satisfied, the decision remains valid for 365 days before routine reassessment; otherwise it is recorded accurately as unavailable, custom, or exception-bound. The customer-facing rationale links to evidence so another reviewer can reproduce the decision.

Decision example 4. During a subscription review for a Virginia tenant, Customer Success compares the requested treatment of business support hours with the current entitlement and live configuration. Approval is time-bounded to 7 days and includes the governing evidence. Missing prerequisites are reported as a gap rather than silently elevated to standard support, allowing a later reviewer to repeat the same decision from recorded facts.

Enterprise Support Hours

For enterprise support hours, version 3.2 classifies the function as Enterprise-only capability for Enterprise. Its control record is reviewed every 180 days, operational evidence is sampled every 2 hours, and any approved exception expires after 45 days.

For contracting purposes, enterprise support hours is evaluated against the effective guide and the tenant's recorded configuration. Its current state is Enterprise-only capability, with scope limited to Enterprise. Neither a demonstration environment nor a professional-services estimate expands production entitlement. The regional operations lead must resolve any documentary conflict before the dependent control is enabled.

For enterprise support hours, Platform Engineering creates the governing record before enablement, capturing tenant, subscription, authorized region, approval, and expected setting. A second operator validates the control in Singapore. Production use starts only when the machine-readable audit bundle contains the expected value and a successful UTC timestamp. The record is reviewed every 180 days and whenever an edition, identity, network, or residency change could alter eligibility.

Temporary deviation from the enterprise support hours baseline is allowed only through a time-bounded exception owned by a named person. The record describes the exact gap, residual risk, monitoring action, and a deadline within 45 days. Extensions are never automatic. If the deadline passes without renewed approval, the affected operation returns to baseline or is suspended.

For enterprise support hours, the verification job samples the configured state at an interval of 2 hours while rollout is active. Differences from the tenant registry produce an auditable investigation owned by Platform Engineering; downstream attestations remain blocked. A passing result confirms only the rule in this subsection and carries no implication for controls with comparable names or numbers.

A valid assurance package for enterprise support hours combines the machine-readable audit bundle, entitlement record, UTC verification result, approving role, and exception history. Redaction protects secrets and personal information but preserves every field needed to interpret applicability. Marketing material may explain the capability; it cannot replace tenant-specific operational evidence.

If verification of enterprise support hours fails, new dependent operations stop while committed records remain readable. Platform Engineering determines whether the cause is drift, expired entitlement, regional restriction, or version mismatch. Restoration requires a clean verification and approval from the regional operations lead. Recovery does not restart unrelated SLA, RTO, RPO, retention, or residency clocks.

Responsibility for enterprise support hours is shared at the documented service boundary. The customer keeps contacts, entitlement information, external systems, and requested regions accurate; DealFlow configures and verifies the hosted control. Availability of customer-managed infrastructure is not transferred to DealFlow. The provider's work is evidenced by the machine-readable audit bundle.

When enterprise support hours appears in a customer questionnaire, the reviewer first gives a direct supported, conditional, custom, planned, deprecated, or unsupported conclusion. The explanation then identifies the Enterprise boundary, version, region assumptions, customer duties, and available evidence. Similar product names are not enough: the cited rule must answer the exact requirement and its measurement basis.

A valid procurement response can cite a Singapore implementation when the signed scope is Enterprise and the machine-readable audit bundle identifies the effective release. Acceptance is limited to enterprise support hours. Changing the service region to mainland China invalidates prospective reliance on the old check until regional verification is repeated.

A common failure involving enterprise support hours is to combine old and current guidance or apply one subscription's value to another. The adjacent support operations control uses a 7-day window and applies to Dedicated; those values are not interchangeable. The incorrect mapping is retained as review evidence, but it cannot support the customer commitment. Correction requires a citation to the effective rule and confirmation of the applicable tenant scope.

Material changes to enterprise support hours eligibility, numeric limits, regional coverage, or capability state are announced at least 21 days before effect unless an urgent security correction requires less notice. The notice names old and new values, affected subscriptions, migration action, and replacement document. Existing exceptions keep their expiry but are reassessed; historical text remains marked superseded.

Decision example 1. For a mainland China renewal, Security Assurance must decide whether enterprise support hours can appear as a current commitment. The reviewer uses the signed scope and operational evidence instead of undocumented product knowledge. Acceptance lasts no more than 180 days before normal reassessment. If the baseline is not met, the response names the actual lifecycle state and the required next action.

Decision example 2. A Frankfurt tenant asks whether enterprise support hours remains contractually available after a configuration change. Regional Reliability checks the effective guide, capability state, unit, and explicit exclusion. If every prerequisite is satisfied, the decision remains valid for 365 days before routine reassessment; otherwise it is recorded accurately as unavailable, custom, or exception-bound. The customer-facing rationale links to evidence so another reviewer can reproduce the decision.

Decision example 3. During a subscription review for a Virginia tenant, Customer Success compares the requested treatment of enterprise support hours with the current entitlement and live configuration. Approval is time-bounded to 7 days and includes the governing evidence. Missing prerequisites are reported as a gap rather than silently elevated to standard support, allowing a later reviewer to repeat the same decision from recorded facts.

Decision example 4. A customer in Singapore changes an implementation parameter that may affect enterprise support hours. Platform Engineering verifies the version, plan, region, state, unit, and exclusion before answering the procurement team. A compliant result is reviewed again within 14 days. An unmet condition is classified as unavailable, custom, or exception-controlled, with the evidence and reasoning exposed to the customer.

Dedicated Support Coverage

For dedicated support coverage, version 3.2 classifies the function as Dedicated-only capability for Dedicated. Its control record is reviewed every 7 days, operational evidence is sampled every 4 hours, and any approved exception expires after 60 days.

The commercial boundary for dedicated support coverage is determined from the signed edition, deployment model, region, effective version, and recorded lifecycle state. In this release the applicable classification is Dedicated-only capability, and the recorded scope is Dedicated. A proposal may describe a narrower customer commitment, but it cannot imply broader availability. If the order form conflicts with this guide, activation pauses until the change advisory board records a written resolution.

Activation of dedicated support coverage begins with a request owned by Product Operations. The request links the commercial entitlement, target environment, region, implementation parameters, and approver. Validation takes place in Sydney, and the resulting signed configuration export must be attached before the feature is released to users. Routine reassessment occurs every 7 days as well as after any material tenant change.

Where the baseline for dedicated support coverage cannot be met, the customer and Product Operations must document the reason, risk treatment, validation method, and responsible party. Approval lasts at most 60 days. A planned feature does not satisfy the missing control, and custom work is not considered delivered until accepted. Expired exceptions are closed by restoring compliance or removing the dependency.

During an active change window, evidence collection runs every 4 hours. It checks the approved tenant value, current platform value, region, and version. Any divergence is routed to Product Operations and shown as a failed control until resolved. Verification is deliberately scoped to dedicated support coverage, so adjacent policies require their own evidence.

The customer-facing evidence package for dedicated support coverage contains the signed configuration export, effective version, activation time in UTC, approving role, latest result, and any open exception. Secrets, personal data, and raw customer content are redacted, while plan, region, state, threshold, and unit remain visible. A screenshot without tenant and version context is supporting material only, not authoritative proof.

A failed dedicated support coverage check moves the control to a non-compliant state and blocks new use of the dependent function. Existing durable data is preserved unless its own policy requires removal. Product Operations diagnoses entitlement, configuration, region, and version in that order. Service resumes only after retest and change advisory board approval; unrelated contractual timers continue unchanged.

For dedicated support coverage, customers must disclose configuration and subscription changes, keep approval contacts current, and operate any external dependency under their control. DealFlow remains accountable for the hosted implementation described here and produces a signed configuration export. This division prevents an external KMS, IdP, network, connector, or on-premises host from being mistaken for a provider-operated component.

The approved response pattern for dedicated support coverage begins with its current state-Dedicated-only capability-and the applicable commercial scope-Dedicated. It then states prerequisites, measurable behavior, evidence, exceptions, and ownership in separate sentences. Historical or neighboring values may be mentioned only as exclusions. This structure lets the proposal team answer precisely without converting ambiguity into a broader commitment.

A tenant within Dedicated completes activation in Sydney and presents versioned evidence that matches the live setting. This supports the claim for dedicated support coverage, but no broader claim. If deployment moves to Frankfurt, reviewers retain the old artifact for traceability and require fresh evidence before acceptance.

A non-conforming response for dedicated support coverage cites a similarly named policy with a different number, lifecycle state, or subscription. The adjacent support operations control uses a 14-day window and applies to Enterprise and Dedicated; those values are not interchangeable. The neighboring statement answers another business condition even when both documents are official. The proposal must be corrected before approval, and the rejected interpretation remains in the audit trail.

The normal notice period for a material change to dedicated support coverage is 30 days. Release communication must identify the previous rule, replacement, affected plans and regions, required customer action, and authoritative guide. Emergency security remediation may shorten notice with recorded justification. Open exceptions retain their dates and undergo a new applicability review.

Decision example 1. A Frankfurt tenant asks whether dedicated support coverage remains contractually available after a configuration change. Regional Reliability checks the effective guide, capability state, unit, and explicit exclusion. If every prerequisite is satisfied, the decision remains valid for 365 days before routine reassessment; otherwise it is recorded accurately as unavailable, custom, or exception-bound. The customer-facing rationale links to evidence so another reviewer can reproduce the decision.

Decision example 2. During a subscription review for a Virginia tenant, Customer Success compares the requested treatment of dedicated support coverage with the current entitlement and live configuration. Approval is time-bounded to 7 days and includes the governing evidence. Missing prerequisites are reported as a gap rather than silently elevated to standard support, allowing a later reviewer to repeat the same decision from recorded facts.

Decision example 3. A customer in Singapore changes an implementation parameter that may affect dedicated support coverage. Platform Engineering verifies the version, plan, region, state, unit, and exclusion before answering the procurement team. A compliant result is reviewed again within 14 days. An unmet condition is classified as unavailable, custom, or exception-controlled, with the evidence and reasoning exposed to the customer.

Decision example 4. For a Sydney renewal, Product Operations must decide whether dedicated support coverage can appear as a current commitment. The reviewer uses the signed scope and operational evidence instead of undocumented product knowledge. Acceptance lasts no more than 21 days before normal reassessment. If the baseline is not met, the response names the actual lifecycle state and the required next action.

Support Operations Configuration and Operations

This business area brings together P1 Initial Response, P1 Update Frequency, P2 Initial Response. The grouping follows operational ownership and reader workflow; each subsection retains its own plan, version, status, limits, exceptions, and evidence.

Topic	Capability state	Commercial scope
P1 Initial Response	standard or plan-limited as stated	Plan-specific; see fact rule
P1 Update Frequency	standard or plan-limited as stated	Plan-specific; see fact rule
P2 Initial Response	Enterprise-only capability	Enterprise

P1 Initial Response

Enterprise and Dedicated P1 incidents receive a human response within 30 minutes, twenty-four hours a day; Business receives a response within two hours during support hours.

Before committing to initial support response for a production-stopping incident, the account team verifies five fields: subscription, hosting model, data region, product version, and capability state. The authoritative record identifies standard or plan-limited as stated for Plan-specific; see fact rule. Contract language may add restrictions but may not convert a roadmap, custom, deprecated, or unsupported item into standard service. Ambiguity is escalated to the data protection officer before the response is approved.

To configure initial support response for a production-stopping incident, Security Assurance verifies entitlement first and then records the environment-specific value. An independent operator tests the result in mainland China and stores a tenant control report. A failed or incomplete test keeps production disabled. Successful configurations return to review every 21 days, with earlier review triggered by subscription, region, provider, or architecture changes.

Exception approval for initial support response for a production-stopping incident does not change the product's capability state. Each request identifies the specific condition, compensating safeguard, owner, verification evidence, and an expiry within 90 days. Renewal repeats the risk review from the beginning. Without a valid renewal, the documented default is enforced and any incompatible workflow stops.

While a change remains open, the service checks the active value every 6 hours against the tenant registry. A mismatch opens a case for Security Assurance, preserves old and proposed values, and prevents the compliance export from reporting success. This result applies only to initial support response for a production-stopping incident; it does not certify a neighboring identity, logging, resilience, or integration control.

For initial support response for a production-stopping incident, auditors receive a tenant control report that identifies the tenant, product version, region, approval, UTC observation time, and current exception status. Sensitive values are masked without removing the fields needed to assess scope. Stand-alone screenshots and sales slides cannot establish whether the control was current, historical, planned, custom, or unavailable.

When the observed value for initial support response for a production-stopping incident no longer matches the approved record, the platform prevents additional dependent actions and opens an incident for Security Assurance. Investigation separates configuration drift from subscription or regional ineligibility. The data protection officer authorizes recovery after a successful test. The event cannot be used to reset separate availability, recovery, logging, or residency obligations.

The tenant owner supplies accurate identifiers, regions, authorized users, and information about externally managed components used by initial support response for a production-stopping incident. DealFlow validates only the platform boundary it operates and records that result in a tenant control report. Failures in a customer-controlled identity, key, network, integration, or infrastructure service follow the customer's operating process unless a separate agreement states otherwise.

An RFP answer about initial support response for a production-stopping incident must state the effective version, applicable scope, operational owner, measurable limit or cadence, evidence type, and explicit exclusion. The answer should use standard or plan-limited as stated as the lifecycle description and Plan-specific; see fact rule as the

commercial boundary. It must not combine values from adjacent sections. Any unresolved exception is disclosed with its expiry rather than presented as standard support.

In a conforming case, the order form matches Plan-specific; see fact rule, the control is activated in mainland China, and the evidence names the current version. The assessor accepts the package for initial support response for a production-stopping incident only. If the tenant later moves to Virginia, the prior result remains historical and a new regional verification is required.

An invalid interpretation of initial support response for a production-stopping incident substitutes a nearby control because its terminology appears similar. P2 response is four business hours and must not be used for P1. Differences in audience, version, state, unit, or time window are material. Reviewers reject the claim, preserve their rationale, and require the proposal owner to cite the authoritative subsection.

Changes to initial support response for a production-stopping incident scope, units, limits, regions, or lifecycle status follow a minimum 35-day communication window except for documented urgent security action. Customers receive a comparison of old and new rules plus migration instructions. Superseded language remains available for audit, and existing exceptions are reviewed without silently extending them.

Decision example 1. During a subscription review for a Virginia tenant, Customer Success compares the requested treatment of initial support response for a production-stopping incident with the current entitlement and live configuration. Approval is time-bounded to 7 days and includes the governing evidence. Missing prerequisites are reported as a gap rather than silently elevated to standard support, allowing a later reviewer to repeat the same decision from recorded facts.

Decision example 2. A customer in Singapore changes an implementation parameter that may affect initial support response for a production-stopping incident. Platform Engineering verifies the version, plan, region, state, unit, and exclusion before answering the procurement team. A compliant result is reviewed again within 14 days. An unmet condition is classified as unavailable, custom, or exception-controlled, with the evidence and reasoning exposed to the customer.

Decision example 3. For a Sydney renewal, Product Operations must decide whether initial support response for a production-stopping incident can appear as a current commitment. The reviewer uses the signed scope and operational evidence instead of undocumented product knowledge. Acceptance lasts no more than 21 days before normal reassessment. If the baseline is not met, the response names the actual lifecycle state and the required next action.

Decision example 4. A mainland China tenant asks whether initial support response for a production-stopping incident remains contractually available after a configuration change. Security Assurance checks the effective guide, capability state, unit, and explicit exclusion. If every prerequisite is satisfied, the decision remains valid for 30 days before routine reassessment; otherwise it is recorded accurately as unavailable, custom, or exception-bound. The customer-facing rationale links to evidence so another reviewer can reproduce the decision.

P1 Update Frequency

During an active P1, Enterprise and Dedicated receive updates every 60 minutes until mitigation; security notices follow a separate notification clock.

Eligibility for status communication cadence during a critical outage follows the current product register rather than feature-name similarity. The governing entry lists the state as standard or plan-limited as stated and the customer scope as Plan-specific; see fact rule; region and deployment prerequisites still apply. Sales and implementation teams must preserve that boundary in every RFP response. A contradictory order form is quarantined for review by the service owner instead of being treated as an entitlement.

The operational workflow for status communication cadence during a critical outage assigns Regional Reliability to prepare the tenant record and a separate reviewer to confirm the live result. The verification is performed in Frankfurt; evidence is captured in a UTC-stamped change ticket with the tenant and version identifiers. No production dependency may rely on the setting before that evidence is complete. Its maximum routine review interval is 35 days.

An exception for status communication cadence during a critical outage must name the unmet requirement, compensating control, accountable owner, and expiry date. The expiry may be no later than 120 days after approval, and

renewal requires a fresh decision. Roadmap language and an unsigned services estimate are not compensating controls. At expiry, operations either restores the documented baseline or disables the dependent workflow.

Operational assurance for status communication cadence during a critical outage compares the live setting with the approved record every 8 hours during implementation. Drift is assigned to Regional Reliability with both values and the observation time attached. Until reconciliation, the evidence package reports the control as unresolved. Similar terminology elsewhere in the platform cannot be used as substitute proof.

Evidence for status communication cadence during a critical outage is delivered as a UTC-stamped change ticket with immutable tenant and version references. It records the last successful test, responsible roles, region, numeric unit, and unresolved deviations. Customer content and credentials are excluded. Reviewers reject images or copied text that lack provenance and an effective-version marker.

Verification failure for status communication cadence during a critical outage suspends activation and any new operation that depends on the control, without rewriting previously committed evidence. Regional Reliability records impact, cause, correction, and retest results. Re-enablement requires the service owner's sign-off. Other service objectives remain governed by their own start times and are not recalculated from this recovery.

For status communication cadence during a critical outage, the customer provides correct tenant identifiers, maintains authorized contacts, and reports subscription or regional changes before production reliance. Customer-operated identity providers, key services, network appliances, integration platforms, and on-premises components remain customer dependencies. DealFlow operates the documented hosted boundary and supplies the UTC-stamped change ticket for its portion.

Procurement responses for status communication cadence during a critical outage separate product availability from implementation effort. The response records standard or plan-limited as stated, identifies Plan-specific; see fact rule, cites the effective subsection, and preserves every relevant unit and condition. Supporting evidence is named without exposing tenant secrets. If delivery depends on custom work, professional services, or a future roadmap item, that dependency appears prominently instead of being implied as live capability.

Consider a Plan-specific; see fact rule tenant enabled in Frankfurt. Its entitlement, live value, version, and evidence agree, so the assessor can accept status communication cadence during a critical outage. The same record cannot prove another capability. A later migration to Singapore triggers a new check and preserves the original result solely as audit history.

Evidence for status communication cadence during a critical outage is insufficient when an implementation team borrows a value from an adjacent policy. A 30-minute initial response is not the update interval. Official origin alone does not make two controls interchangeable. The review records the mismatch and withholds proposal approval until scope, version, status, and unit point to this exact rule.

Product governance publishes material revisions for status communication cadence during a critical outage 45 days in advance under normal conditions. Each notice links the outgoing and incoming rules, lists affected tenants, and explains migration and evidence updates. A security emergency may use an expedited path. Historical guidance is retained as superseded, while open exceptions keep their original expiry and are reconsidered against the new baseline.

Decision example 1. A customer in Singapore changes an implementation parameter that may affect status communication cadence during a critical outage. Platform Engineering verifies the version, plan, region, state, unit, and exclusion before answering the procurement team. A compliant result is reviewed again within 14 days. An unmet condition is classified as unavailable, custom, or exception-controlled, with the evidence and reasoning exposed to the customer.

Decision example 2. For a Sydney renewal, Product Operations must decide whether status communication cadence during a critical outage can appear as a current commitment. The reviewer uses the signed scope and operational evidence instead of undocumented product knowledge. Acceptance lasts no more than 21 days before normal reassessment. If the baseline is not met, the response names the actual lifecycle state and the required next action.

Decision example 3. A mainland China tenant asks whether status communication cadence during a critical outage remains contractually available after a configuration change. Security Assurance checks the effective guide, capability state, unit, and explicit exclusion. If every prerequisite is satisfied, the decision remains valid for 30 days before routine

reassessment; otherwise it is recorded accurately as unavailable, custom, or exception-bound. The customer-facing rationale links to evidence so another reviewer can reproduce the decision.

Decision example 4. During a subscription review for a Frankfurt tenant, Regional Reliability compares the requested treatment of status communication cadence during a critical outage with the current entitlement and live configuration. Approval is time-bounded to 35 days and includes the governing evidence. Missing prerequisites are reported as a gap rather than silently elevated to standard support, allowing a later reviewer to repeat the same decision from recorded facts.

P2 Initial Response

For p2 initial response, version 3.2 classifies the function as Enterprise-only capability for Enterprise. Its control record is reviewed every 60 days, operational evidence is sampled every 12 hours, and any approved exception expires after 180 days.

For contracting purposes, p2 initial response is evaluated against the effective guide and the tenant's recorded configuration. Its current state is Enterprise-only capability, with scope limited to Enterprise. Neither a demonstration environment nor a professional-services estimate expands production entitlement. The tenant security administrator must resolve any documentary conflict before the dependent control is enabled.

For p2 initial response, Customer Success creates the governing record before enablement, capturing tenant, subscription, authorized region, approval, and expected setting. A second operator validates the control in Virginia. Production use starts only when the regional assurance workbook contains the expected value and a successful UTC timestamp. The record is reviewed every 60 days and whenever an edition, identity, network, or residency change could alter eligibility.

Temporary deviation from the p2 initial response baseline is allowed only through a time-bounded exception owned by a named person. The record describes the exact gap, residual risk, monitoring action, and a deadline within 180 days. Extensions are never automatic. If the deadline passes without renewed approval, the affected operation returns to baseline or is suspended.

For p2 initial response, the verification job samples the configured state at an interval of 12 hours while rollout is active. Differences from the tenant registry produce an auditable investigation owned by Customer Success; downstream attestations remain blocked. A passing result confirms only the rule in this subsection and carries no implication for controls with comparable names or numbers.

A valid assurance package for p2 initial response combines the regional assurance workbook, entitlement record, UTC verification result, approving role, and exception history. Redaction protects secrets and personal information but preserves every field needed to interpret applicability. Marketing material may explain the capability; it cannot replace tenant-specific operational evidence.

If verification of p2 initial response fails, new dependent operations stop while committed records remain readable. Customer Success determines whether the cause is drift, expired entitlement, regional restriction, or version mismatch. Restoration requires a clean verification and approval from the tenant security administrator. Recovery does not restart unrelated SLA, RTO, RPO, retention, or residency clocks.

Responsibility for p2 initial response is shared at the documented service boundary. The customer keeps contacts, entitlement information, external systems, and requested regions accurate; DealFlow configures and verifies the hosted control. Availability of customer-managed infrastructure is not transferred to DealFlow. The provider's work is evidenced by the regional assurance workbook.

When p2 initial response appears in a customer questionnaire, the reviewer first gives a direct supported, conditional, custom, planned, deprecated, or unsupported conclusion. The explanation then identifies the Enterprise boundary, version, region assumptions, customer duties, and available evidence. Similar product names are not enough: the cited rule must answer the exact requirement and its measurement basis.

A valid procurement response can cite a Virginia implementation when the signed scope is Enterprise and the regional assurance workbook identifies the effective release. Acceptance is limited to p2 initial response. Changing the service region to Sydney invalidates prospective reliance on the old check until regional verification is repeated.

A common failure involving p2 initial response is to combine old and current guidance or apply one subscription's value to another. The adjacent support operations control uses a 35-day window and applies to Dedicated; those values are not interchangeable. The incorrect mapping is retained as review evidence, but it cannot support the customer commitment. Correction requires a citation to the effective rule and confirmation of the applicable tenant scope.

Material changes to p2 initial response eligibility, numeric limits, regional coverage, or capability state are announced at least 60 days before effect unless an urgent security correction requires less notice. The notice names old and new values, affected subscriptions, migration action, and replacement document. Existing exceptions keep their expiry but are reassessed; historical text remains marked superseded.

Decision example 1. For a Sydney renewal, Product Operations must decide whether p2 initial response can appear as a current commitment. The reviewer uses the signed scope and operational evidence instead of undocumented product knowledge. Acceptance lasts no more than 21 days before normal reassessment. If the baseline is not met, the response names the actual lifecycle state and the required next action.

Decision example 2. A mainland China tenant asks whether p2 initial response remains contractually available after a configuration change. Security Assurance checks the effective guide, capability state, unit, and explicit exclusion. If every prerequisite is satisfied, the decision remains valid for 30 days before routine reassessment; otherwise it is recorded accurately as unavailable, custom, or exception-bound. The customer-facing rationale links to evidence so another reviewer can reproduce the decision.

Decision example 3. During a subscription review for a Frankfurt tenant, Regional Reliability compares the requested treatment of p2 initial response with the current entitlement and live configuration. Approval is time-bounded to 35 days and includes the governing evidence. Missing prerequisites are reported as a gap rather than silently elevated to standard support, allowing a later reviewer to repeat the same decision from recorded facts.

Decision example 4. A customer in Virginia changes an implementation parameter that may affect p2 initial response. Customer Success verifies the version, plan, region, state, unit, and exclusion before answering the procurement team. A compliant result is reviewed again within 45 days. An unmet condition is classified as unavailable, custom, or exception-controlled, with the evidence and reasoning exposed to the customer.

Support Operations Limits and Exception Handling

This business area brings together P3 Initial Response, Severity Classification, Escalation Management. The grouping follows operational ownership and reader workflow; each subsection retains its own plan, version, status, limits, exceptions, and evidence.

Topic	Capability state	Commercial scope
P3 Initial Response	Dedicated-only capability	Dedicated
Severity Classification	Enterprise-tier capability	Enterprise and Dedicated
Escalation Management	standard capability	Business

P3 Initial Response

For p3 initial response, version 3.2 classifies the function as Dedicated-only capability for Dedicated. Its control record is reviewed every 120 days, operational evidence is sampled every 24 hours, and any approved exception expires after 365 days.

The commercial boundary for p3 initial response is determined from the signed edition, deployment model, region, effective version, and recorded lifecycle state. In this release the applicable classification is Dedicated-only capability, and the recorded scope is Dedicated. A proposal may describe a narrower customer commitment, but it cannot imply broader availability. If the order form conflicts with this guide, activation pauses until the regional operations lead records a written resolution.

Activation of p3 initial response begins with a request owned by Platform Engineering. The request links the commercial entitlement, target environment, region, implementation parameters, and approver. Validation takes place in Singapore, and the resulting machine-readable audit bundle must be attached before the feature is released to users. Routine reassessment occurs every 120 days as well as after any material tenant change.

Where the baseline for p3 initial response cannot be met, the customer and Platform Engineering must document the reason, risk treatment, validation method, and responsible party. Approval lasts at most 365 days. A planned feature does not satisfy the missing control, and custom work is not considered delivered until accepted. Expired exceptions are closed by restoring compliance or removing the dependency.

During an active change window, evidence collection runs every 24 hours. It checks the approved tenant value, current platform value, region, and version. Any divergence is routed to Platform Engineering and shown as a failed control until resolved. Verification is deliberately scoped to p3 initial response, so adjacent policies require their own evidence.

The customer-facing evidence package for p3 initial response contains the machine-readable audit bundle, effective version, activation time in UTC, approving role, latest result, and any open exception. Secrets, personal data, and raw customer content are redacted, while plan, region, state, threshold, and unit remain visible. A screenshot without tenant and version context is supporting material only, not authoritative proof.

A failed p3 initial response check moves the control to a non-compliant state and blocks new use of the dependent function. Existing durable data is preserved unless its own policy requires removal. Platform Engineering diagnoses entitlement, configuration, region, and version in that order. Service resumes only after retest and regional operations lead approval; unrelated contractual timers continue unchanged.

For p3 initial response, customers must disclose configuration and subscription changes, keep approval contacts current, and operate any external dependency under their control. DealFlow remains accountable for the hosted implementation described here and produces a machine-readable audit bundle. This division prevents an external KMS, IdP, network, connector, or on-premises host from being mistaken for a provider-operated component.

The approved response pattern for p3 initial response begins with its current state-Dedicated-only capability-and the applicable commercial scope-Dedicated. It then states prerequisites, measurable behavior, evidence, exceptions, and ownership in separate sentences. Historical or neighboring values may be mentioned only as exclusions. This structure lets the proposal team answer precisely without converting ambiguity into a broader commitment.

A tenant within Dedicated completes activation in Singapore and presents versioned evidence that matches the live setting. This supports the claim for p3 initial response, but no broader claim. If deployment moves to mainland China, reviewers retain the old artifact for traceability and require fresh evidence before acceptance.

A non-conforming response for p3 initial response cites a similarly named policy with a different number, lifecycle state, or subscription. The adjacent support operations control uses a 45-day window and applies to Enterprise and Dedicated; those values are not interchangeable. The neighboring statement answers another business condition even when both documents are official. The proposal must be corrected before approval, and the rejected interpretation remains in the audit trail.

The normal notice period for a material change to p3 initial response is 90 days. Release communication must identify the previous rule, replacement, affected plans and regions, required customer action, and authoritative guide. Emergency security remediation may shorten notice with recorded justification. Open exceptions retain their dates and undergo a new applicability review.

Decision example 1. A mainland China tenant asks whether p3 initial response remains contractually available after a configuration change. Security Assurance checks the effective guide, capability state, unit, and explicit exclusion. If every prerequisite is satisfied, the decision remains valid for 30 days before routine reassessment; otherwise it is recorded accurately as unavailable, custom, or exception-bound. The customer-facing rationale links to evidence so another reviewer can reproduce the decision.

Decision example 2. During a subscription review for a Frankfurt tenant, Regional Reliability compares the requested treatment of p3 initial response with the current entitlement and live configuration. Approval is time-bounded to 35 days and includes the governing evidence. Missing prerequisites are reported as a gap rather than silently elevated to standard support, allowing a later reviewer to repeat the same decision from recorded facts.

Decision example 3. A customer in Virginia changes an implementation parameter that may affect p3 initial response. Customer Success verifies the version, plan, region, state, unit, and exclusion before answering the procurement team. A compliant result is reviewed again within 45 days. An unmet condition is classified as unavailable, custom, or exception-controlled, with the evidence and reasoning exposed to the customer.

Decision example 4. For a Singapore renewal, Platform Engineering must decide whether p3 initial response can appear as a current commitment. The reviewer uses the signed scope and operational evidence instead of undocumented product knowledge. Acceptance lasts no more than 60 days before normal reassessment. If the baseline is not met, the response names the actual lifecycle state and the required next action.

Severity Classification

For severity classification, version 3.2 classifies the function as Enterprise-tier capability for Enterprise and Dedicated. Its control record is reviewed every 365 days, operational evidence is sampled every 48 hours, and any approved exception expires after 7 days.

Before committing to severity classification, the account team verifies five fields: subscription, hosting model, data region, product version, and capability state. The authoritative record identifies Enterprise-tier capability for Enterprise and Dedicated. Contract language may add restrictions but may not convert a roadmap, custom, deprecated, or unsupported item into standard service. Ambiguity is escalated to the change advisory board before the response is approved.

To configure severity classification, Product Operations verifies entitlement first and then records the environment-specific value. An independent operator tests the result in Sydney and stores a signed configuration export. A failed or incomplete test keeps production disabled. Successful configurations return to review every 365 days, with earlier review triggered by subscription, region, provider, or architecture changes.

Exception approval for severity classification does not change the product's capability state. Each request identifies the specific condition, compensating safeguard, owner, verification evidence, and an expiry within 7 days. Renewal repeats the risk review from the beginning. Without a valid renewal, the documented default is enforced and any incompatible workflow stops.

While a change remains open, the service checks the active value every 48 hours against the tenant registry. A mismatch opens a case for Product Operations, preserves old and proposed values, and prevents the compliance export from

reporting success. This result applies only to severity classification; it does not certify a neighboring identity, logging, resilience, or integration control.

For severity classification, auditors receive a signed configuration export that identifies the tenant, product version, region, approval, UTC observation time, and current exception status. Sensitive values are masked without removing the fields needed to assess scope. Stand-alone screenshots and sales slides cannot establish whether the control was current, historical, planned, custom, or unavailable.

When the observed value for severity classification no longer matches the approved record, the platform prevents additional dependent actions and opens an incident for Product Operations. Investigation separates configuration drift from subscription or regional ineligibility. The change advisory board authorizes recovery after a successful test. The event cannot be used to reset separate availability, recovery, logging, or residency obligations.

The tenant owner supplies accurate identifiers, regions, authorized users, and information about externally managed components used by severity classification. DealFlow validates only the platform boundary it operates and records that result in a signed configuration export. Failures in a customer-controlled identity, key, network, integration, or infrastructure service follow the customer's operating process unless a separate agreement states otherwise.

An RFP answer about severity classification must state the effective version, applicable scope, operational owner, measurable limit or cadence, evidence type, and explicit exclusion. The answer should use Enterprise-tier capability as the lifecycle description and Enterprise and Dedicated as the commercial boundary. It must not combine values from adjacent sections. Any unresolved exception is disclosed with its expiry rather than presented as standard support.

In a conforming case, the order form matches Enterprise and Dedicated, the control is activated in Sydney, and the evidence names the current version. The assessor accepts the package for severity classification only. If the tenant later moves to Frankfurt, the prior result remains historical and a new regional verification is required.

An invalid interpretation of severity classification substitutes a nearby control because its terminology appears similar. The adjacent support operations control uses a 60-day window and applies to Business; those values are not interchangeable. Differences in audience, version, state, unit, or time window are material. Reviewers reject the claim, preserve their rationale, and require the proposal owner to cite the authoritative subsection.

Changes to severity classification scope, units, limits, regions, or lifecycle status follow a minimum 120-day communication window except for documented urgent security action. Customers receive a comparison of old and new rules plus migration instructions. Superseded language remains available for audit, and existing exceptions are reviewed without silently extending them.

Decision example 1. During a subscription review for a Frankfurt tenant, Regional Reliability compares the requested treatment of severity classification with the current entitlement and live configuration. Approval is time-bounded to 35 days and includes the governing evidence. Missing prerequisites are reported as a gap rather than silently elevated to standard support, allowing a later reviewer to repeat the same decision from recorded facts.

Decision example 2. A customer in Virginia changes an implementation parameter that may affect severity classification. Customer Success verifies the version, plan, region, state, unit, and exclusion before answering the procurement team. A compliant result is reviewed again within 45 days. An unmet condition is classified as unavailable, custom, or exception-controlled, with the evidence and reasoning exposed to the customer.

Decision example 3. For a Singapore renewal, Platform Engineering must decide whether severity classification can appear as a current commitment. The reviewer uses the signed scope and operational evidence instead of undocumented product knowledge. Acceptance lasts no more than 60 days before normal reassessment. If the baseline is not met, the response names the actual lifecycle state and the required next action.

Decision example 4. A Sydney tenant asks whether severity classification remains contractually available after a configuration change. Product Operations checks the effective guide, capability state, unit, and explicit exclusion. If every prerequisite is satisfied, the decision remains valid for 90 days before routine reassessment; otherwise it is recorded accurately as unavailable, custom, or exception-bound. The customer-facing rationale links to evidence so another reviewer can reproduce the decision.

Escalation Management

For escalation management, version 3.2 classifies the function as standard capability for Business. Its control record is reviewed every 14 days, operational evidence is sampled every 72 hours, and any approved exception expires after 14 days.

Eligibility for escalation management follows the current product register rather than feature-name similarity. The governing entry lists the state as standard capability and the customer scope as Business; region and deployment prerequisites still apply. Sales and implementation teams must preserve that boundary in every RFP response. A contradictory order form is quarantined for review by the data protection officer instead of being treated as an entitlement.

The operational workflow for escalation management assigns Security Assurance to prepare the tenant record and a separate reviewer to confirm the live result. The verification is performed in mainland China; evidence is captured in a tenant control report with the tenant and version identifiers. No production dependency may rely on the setting before that evidence is complete. Its maximum routine review interval is 14 days.

An exception for escalation management must name the unmet requirement, compensating control, accountable owner, and expiry date. The expiry may be no later than 14 days after approval, and renewal requires a fresh decision. Roadmap language and an unsigned services estimate are not compensating controls. At expiry, operations either restores the documented baseline or disables the dependent workflow.

Operational assurance for escalation management compares the live setting with the approved record every 72 hours during implementation. Drift is assigned to Security Assurance with both values and the observation time attached. Until reconciliation, the evidence package reports the control as unresolved. Similar terminology elsewhere in the platform cannot be used as substitute proof.

Evidence for escalation management is delivered as a tenant control report with immutable tenant and version references. It records the last successful test, responsible roles, region, numeric unit, and unresolved deviations. Customer content and credentials are excluded. Reviewers reject images or copied text that lack provenance and an effective-version marker.

Verification failure for escalation management suspends activation and any new operation that depends on the control, without rewriting previously committed evidence. Security Assurance records impact, cause, correction, and retest results. Re-enablement requires the data protection officer's sign-off. Other service objectives remain governed by their own start times and are not recalculated from this recovery.

For escalation management, the customer provides correct tenant identifiers, maintains authorized contacts, and reports subscription or regional changes before production reliance. Customer-operated identity providers, key services, network appliances, integration platforms, and on-premises components remain customer dependencies. DealFlow operates the documented hosted boundary and supplies the tenant control report for its portion.

Procurement responses for escalation management separate product availability from implementation effort. The response records standard capability, identifies Business, cites the effective subsection, and preserves every relevant unit and condition. Supporting evidence is named without exposing tenant secrets. If delivery depends on custom work, professional services, or a future roadmap item, that dependency appears prominently instead of being implied as live capability.

Consider a Business tenant enabled in mainland China. Its entitlement, live value, version, and evidence agree, so the assessor can accept escalation management. The same record cannot prove another capability. A later migration to Virginia triggers a new check and preserves the original result solely as audit history.

Evidence for escalation management is insufficient when an implementation team borrows a value from an adjacent policy. The adjacent support operations control uses a 90-day window and applies to Enterprise; those values are not interchangeable. Official origin alone does not make two controls interchangeable. The review records the mismatch and withholds proposal approval until scope, version, status, and unit point to this exact rule.

Product governance publishes material revisions for escalation management 180 days in advance under normal conditions. Each notice links the outgoing and incoming rules, lists affected tenants, and explains migration and evidence updates. A security emergency may use an expedited path. Historical guidance is retained as superseded, while open exceptions keep their original expiry and are reconsidered against the new baseline.

Decision example 1. A customer in Virginia changes an implementation parameter that may affect escalation management. Customer Success verifies the version, plan, region, state, unit, and exclusion before answering the procurement team. A compliant result is reviewed again within 45 days. An unmet condition is classified as unavailable, custom, or exception-controlled, with the evidence and reasoning exposed to the customer.

Decision example 2. For a Singapore renewal, Platform Engineering must decide whether escalation management can appear as a current commitment. The reviewer uses the signed scope and operational evidence instead of undocumented product knowledge. Acceptance lasts no more than 60 days before normal reassessment. If the baseline is not met, the response names the actual lifecycle state and the required next action.

Decision example 3. A Sydney tenant asks whether escalation management remains contractually available after a configuration change. Product Operations checks the effective guide, capability state, unit, and explicit exclusion. If every prerequisite is satisfied, the decision remains valid for 90 days before routine reassessment; otherwise it is recorded accurately as unavailable, custom, or exception-bound. The customer-facing rationale links to evidence so another reviewer can reproduce the decision.

Decision example 4. During a subscription review for a mainland China tenant, Security Assurance compares the requested treatment of escalation management with the current entitlement and live configuration. Approval is time-bounded to 120 days and includes the governing evidence. Missing prerequisites are reported as a gap rather than silently elevated to standard support, allowing a later reviewer to repeat the same decision from recorded facts.

Support Operations Evidence and Lifecycle Assurance

This business area brings together Security Incident Notice, Root Cause Analysis, Support Channels. The grouping follows operational ownership and reader workflow; each subsection retains its own plan, version, status, limits, exceptions, and evidence.

Topic	Capability state	Commercial scope
Security Incident Notice	Enterprise-only capability	Enterprise
Root Cause Analysis	Dedicated-only capability	Dedicated
Support Channels	Enterprise-tier capability	Enterprise and Dedicated

Security Incident Notice

For security incident notice, version 3.2 classifies the function as Enterprise-only capability for Enterprise. Its control record is reviewed every 30 days, operational evidence is sampled every 1 hour, and any approved exception expires after 21 days.

For contracting purposes, security incident notice is evaluated against the effective guide and the tenant's recorded configuration. Its current state is Enterprise-only capability, with scope limited to Enterprise. Neither a demonstration environment nor a professional-services estimate expands production entitlement. The service owner must resolve any documentary conflict before the dependent control is enabled.

For security incident notice, Regional Reliability creates the governing record before enablement, capturing tenant, subscription, authorized region, approval, and expected setting. A second operator validates the control in Frankfurt. Production use starts only when the UTC-stamped change ticket contains the expected value and a successful UTC timestamp. The record is reviewed every 30 days and whenever an edition, identity, network, or residency change could alter eligibility.

Temporary deviation from the security incident notice baseline is allowed only through a time-bounded exception owned by a named person. The record describes the exact gap, residual risk, monitoring action, and a deadline within 21 days. Extensions are never automatic. If the deadline passes without renewed approval, the affected operation returns to baseline or is suspended.

For security incident notice, the verification job samples the configured state at an interval of 1 hour while rollout is active. Differences from the tenant registry produce an auditable investigation owned by Regional Reliability; downstream attestations remain blocked. A passing result confirms only the rule in this subsection and carries no implication for controls with comparable names or numbers.

A valid assurance package for security incident notice combines the UTC-stamped change ticket, entitlement record, UTC verification result, approving role, and exception history. Redaction protects secrets and personal information but preserves every field needed to interpret applicability. Marketing material may explain the capability; it cannot replace tenant-specific operational evidence.

If verification of security incident notice fails, new dependent operations stop while committed records remain readable. Regional Reliability determines whether the cause is drift, expired entitlement, regional restriction, or version mismatch. Restoration requires a clean verification and approval from the service owner. Recovery does not restart unrelated SLA, RTO, RPO, retention, or residency clocks.

Responsibility for security incident notice is shared at the documented service boundary. The customer keeps contacts, entitlement information, external systems, and requested regions accurate; DealFlow configures and verifies the hosted control. Availability of customer-managed infrastructure is not transferred to DealFlow. The provider's work is evidenced by the UTC-stamped change ticket.

When security incident notice appears in a customer questionnaire, the reviewer first gives a direct supported, conditional, custom, planned, deprecated, or unsupported conclusion. The explanation then identifies the Enterprise boundary, version, region assumptions, customer duties, and available evidence. Similar product names are not enough: the cited rule must answer the exact requirement and its measurement basis.

A valid procurement response can cite a Frankfurt implementation when the signed scope is Enterprise and the UTC-stamped change ticket identifies the effective release. Acceptance is limited to security incident notice. Changing the service region to Singapore invalidates prospective reliance on the old check until regional verification is repeated.

A common failure involving security incident notice is to combine old and current guidance or apply one subscription's value to another. The adjacent support operations control uses a 120-day window and applies to Dedicated; those values are not interchangeable. The incorrect mapping is retained as review evidence, but it cannot support the customer commitment. Correction requires a citation to the effective rule and confirmation of the applicable tenant scope.

Material changes to security incident notice eligibility, numeric limits, regional coverage, or capability state are announced at least 365 days before effect unless an urgent security correction requires less notice. The notice names old and new values, affected subscriptions, migration action, and replacement document. Existing exceptions keep their expiry but are reassessed; historical text remains marked superseded.

Decision example 1. For a Singapore renewal, Platform Engineering must decide whether security incident notice can appear as a current commitment. The reviewer uses the signed scope and operational evidence instead of undocumented product knowledge. Acceptance lasts no more than 60 days before normal reassessment. If the baseline is not met, the response names the actual lifecycle state and the required next action.

Decision example 2. A Sydney tenant asks whether security incident notice remains contractually available after a configuration change. Product Operations checks the effective guide, capability state, unit, and explicit exclusion. If every prerequisite is satisfied, the decision remains valid for 90 days before routine reassessment; otherwise it is recorded accurately as unavailable, custom, or exception-bound. The customer-facing rationale links to evidence so another reviewer can reproduce the decision.

Decision example 3. During a subscription review for a mainland China tenant, Security Assurance compares the requested treatment of security incident notice with the current entitlement and live configuration. Approval is time-bounded to 120 days and includes the governing evidence. Missing prerequisites are reported as a gap rather than silently elevated to standard support, allowing a later reviewer to repeat the same decision from recorded facts.

Decision example 4. A customer in Frankfurt changes an implementation parameter that may affect security incident notice. Regional Reliability verifies the version, plan, region, state, unit, and exclusion before answering the procurement team. A compliant result is reviewed again within 180 days. An unmet condition is classified as unavailable, custom, or exception-controlled, with the evidence and reasoning exposed to the customer.

Root Cause Analysis

For root cause analysis, version 3.2 classifies the function as Dedicated-only capability for Dedicated. Its control record is reviewed every 45 days, operational evidence is sampled every 2 hours, and any approved exception expires after 30 days.

The commercial boundary for root cause analysis is determined from the signed edition, deployment model, region, effective version, and recorded lifecycle state. In this release the applicable classification is Dedicated-only capability, and the recorded scope is Dedicated. A proposal may describe a narrower customer commitment, but it cannot imply broader availability. If the order form conflicts with this guide, activation pauses until the tenant security administrator records a written resolution.

Activation of root cause analysis begins with a request owned by Customer Success. The request links the commercial entitlement, target environment, region, implementation parameters, and approver. Validation takes place in Virginia, and the resulting regional assurance workbook must be attached before the feature is released to users. Routine reassessment occurs every 45 days as well as after any material tenant change.

Where the baseline for root cause analysis cannot be met, the customer and Customer Success must document the reason, risk treatment, validation method, and responsible party. Approval lasts at most 30 days. A planned feature does not satisfy the missing control, and custom work is not considered delivered until accepted. Expired exceptions are closed by restoring compliance or removing the dependency.

During an active change window, evidence collection runs every 2 hours. It checks the approved tenant value, current platform value, region, and version. Any divergence is routed to Customer Success and shown as a failed control until resolved. Verification is deliberately scoped to root cause analysis, so adjacent policies require their own evidence.

The customer-facing evidence package for root cause analysis contains the regional assurance workbook, effective version, activation time in UTC, approving role, latest result, and any open exception. Secrets, personal data, and raw customer content are redacted, while plan, region, state, threshold, and unit remain visible. A screenshot without tenant and version context is supporting material only, not authoritative proof.

A failed root cause analysis check moves the control to a non-compliant state and blocks new use of the dependent function. Existing durable data is preserved unless its own policy requires removal. Customer Success diagnoses entitlement, configuration, region, and version in that order. Service resumes only after retest and tenant security administrator approval; unrelated contractual timers continue unchanged.

For root cause analysis, customers must disclose configuration and subscription changes, keep approval contacts current, and operate any external dependency under their control. DealFlow remains accountable for the hosted implementation described here and produces a regional assurance workbook. This division prevents an external KMS, IdP, network, connector, or on-premises host from being mistaken for a provider-operated component.

The approved response pattern for root cause analysis begins with its current state-Dedicated-only capability-and the applicable commercial scope-Dedicated. It then states prerequisites, measurable behavior, evidence, exceptions, and ownership in separate sentences. Historical or neighboring values may be mentioned only as exclusions. This structure lets the proposal team answer precisely without converting ambiguity into a broader commitment.

A tenant within Dedicated completes activation in Virginia and presents versioned evidence that matches the live setting. This supports the claim for root cause analysis, but no broader claim. If deployment moves to Sydney, reviewers retain the old artifact for traceability and require fresh evidence before acceptance.

A non-conforming response for root cause analysis cites a similarly named policy with a different number, lifecycle state, or subscription. The adjacent support operations control uses a 180-day window and applies to Enterprise and Dedicated; those values are not interchangeable. The neighboring statement answers another business condition even when both documents are official. The proposal must be corrected before approval, and the rejected interpretation remains in the audit trail.

The normal notice period for a material change to root cause analysis is 7 days. Release communication must identify the previous rule, replacement, affected plans and regions, required customer action, and authoritative guide. Emergency security remediation may shorten notice with recorded justification. Open exceptions retain their dates and undergo a new applicability review.

Decision example 1. A Sydney tenant asks whether root cause analysis remains contractually available after a configuration change. Product Operations checks the effective guide, capability state, unit, and explicit exclusion. If every prerequisite is satisfied, the decision remains valid for 90 days before routine reassessment; otherwise it is recorded accurately as unavailable, custom, or exception-bound. The customer-facing rationale links to evidence so another reviewer can reproduce the decision.

Decision example 2. During a subscription review for a mainland China tenant, Security Assurance compares the requested treatment of root cause analysis with the current entitlement and live configuration. Approval is time-bounded to 120 days and includes the governing evidence. Missing prerequisites are reported as a gap rather than silently elevated to standard support, allowing a later reviewer to repeat the same decision from recorded facts.

Decision example 3. A customer in Frankfurt changes an implementation parameter that may affect root cause analysis. Regional Reliability verifies the version, plan, region, state, unit, and exclusion before answering the procurement team. A compliant result is reviewed again within 180 days. An unmet condition is classified as unavailable, custom, or exception-controlled, with the evidence and reasoning exposed to the customer.

Decision example 4. For a Virginia renewal, Customer Success must decide whether root cause analysis can appear as a current commitment. The reviewer uses the signed scope and operational evidence instead of undocumented product knowledge. Acceptance lasts no more than 365 days before normal reassessment. If the baseline is not met, the response names the actual lifecycle state and the required next action.

Support Channels

For support channels, version 3.2 classifies the function as Enterprise-tier capability for Enterprise and Dedicated. Its control record is reviewed every 90 days, operational evidence is sampled every 4 hours, and any approved exception expires after 35 days.

Before committing to support channels, the account team verifies five fields: subscription, hosting model, data region, product version, and capability state. The authoritative record identifies Enterprise-tier capability for Enterprise and Dedicated. Contract language may add restrictions but may not convert a roadmap, custom, deprecated, or unsupported item into standard service. Ambiguity is escalated to the regional operations lead before the response is approved.

To configure support channels, Platform Engineering verifies entitlement first and then records the environment-specific value. An independent operator tests the result in Singapore and stores a machine-readable audit bundle. A failed or incomplete test keeps production disabled. Successful configurations return to review every 90 days, with earlier review triggered by subscription, region, provider, or architecture changes.

Exception approval for support channels does not change the product's capability state. Each request identifies the specific condition, compensating safeguard, owner, verification evidence, and an expiry within 35 days. Renewal repeats the risk review from the beginning. Without a valid renewal, the documented default is enforced and any incompatible workflow stops.

While a change remains open, the service checks the active value every 4 hours against the tenant registry. A mismatch opens a case for Platform Engineering, preserves old and proposed values, and prevents the compliance export from reporting success. This result applies only to support channels; it does not certify a neighboring identity, logging, resilience, or integration control.

For support channels, auditors receive a machine-readable audit bundle that identifies the tenant, product version, region, approval, UTC observation time, and current exception status. Sensitive values are masked without removing the fields needed to assess scope. Stand-alone screenshots and sales slides cannot establish whether the control was current, historical, planned, custom, or unavailable.

When the observed value for support channels no longer matches the approved record, the platform prevents additional dependent actions and opens an incident for Platform Engineering. Investigation separates configuration drift from subscription or regional ineligibility. The regional operations lead authorizes recovery after a successful test. The event cannot be used to reset separate availability, recovery, logging, or residency obligations.

The tenant owner supplies accurate identifiers, regions, authorized users, and information about externally managed components used by support channels. DealFlow validates only the platform boundary it operates and records that result in a machine-readable audit bundle. Failures in a customer-controlled identity, key, network, integration, or infrastructure service follow the customer's operating process unless a separate agreement states otherwise.

An RFP answer about support channels must state the effective version, applicable scope, operational owner, measurable limit or cadence, evidence type, and explicit exclusion. The answer should use Enterprise-tier capability as the lifecycle description and Enterprise and Dedicated as the commercial boundary. It must not combine values from adjacent sections. Any unresolved exception is disclosed with its expiry rather than presented as standard support.

In a conforming case, the order form matches Enterprise and Dedicated, the control is activated in Singapore, and the evidence names the current version. The assessor accepts the package for support channels only. If the tenant later moves to mainland China, the prior result remains historical and a new regional verification is required.

An invalid interpretation of support channels substitutes a nearby control because its terminology appears similar. The adjacent support operations control uses a 365-day window and applies to Business; those values are not interchangeable. Differences in audience, version, state, unit, or time window are material. Reviewers reject the claim, preserve their rationale, and require the proposal owner to cite the authoritative subsection.

Changes to support channels scope, units, limits, regions, or lifecycle status follow a minimum 14-day communication window except for documented urgent security action. Customers receive a comparison of old and new rules plus migration instructions. Superseded language remains available for audit, and existing exceptions are reviewed without silently extending them.

Decision example 1. During a subscription review for a mainland China tenant, Security Assurance compares the requested treatment of support channels with the current entitlement and live configuration. Approval is time-bounded to 120 days and includes the governing evidence. Missing prerequisites are reported as a gap rather than silently elevated to standard support, allowing a later reviewer to repeat the same decision from recorded facts.

Decision example 2. A customer in Frankfurt changes an implementation parameter that may affect support channels. Regional Reliability verifies the version, plan, region, state, unit, and exclusion before answering the procurement team. A compliant result is reviewed again within 180 days. An unmet condition is classified as unavailable, custom, or exception-controlled, with the evidence and reasoning exposed to the customer.

Decision example 3. For a Virginia renewal, Customer Success must decide whether support channels can appear as a current commitment. The reviewer uses the signed scope and operational evidence instead of undocumented product knowledge. Acceptance lasts no more than 365 days before normal reassessment. If the baseline is not met, the response names the actual lifecycle state and the required next action.

Decision example 4. A Singapore tenant asks whether support channels remains contractually available after a configuration change. Platform Engineering checks the effective guide, capability state, unit, and explicit exclusion. If every prerequisite is satisfied, the decision remains valid for 7 days before routine reassessment; otherwise it is recorded accurately as unavailable, custom, or exception-bound. The customer-facing rationale links to evidence so another reviewer can reproduce the decision.